

Supplementary Material

Three Equivalent Routes to Estimating Power Spectra: Averaging, Multitaper, and Smoothing

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Figure, table and equation numbers without an “S” refer to the main text, whose notation (Section II-A there) is used throughout: R is the design resolution, $\alpha = N\Delta R/2$ the time-bandwidth product, L the number of tapers, and widths are in units of $1/(N\Delta)$.

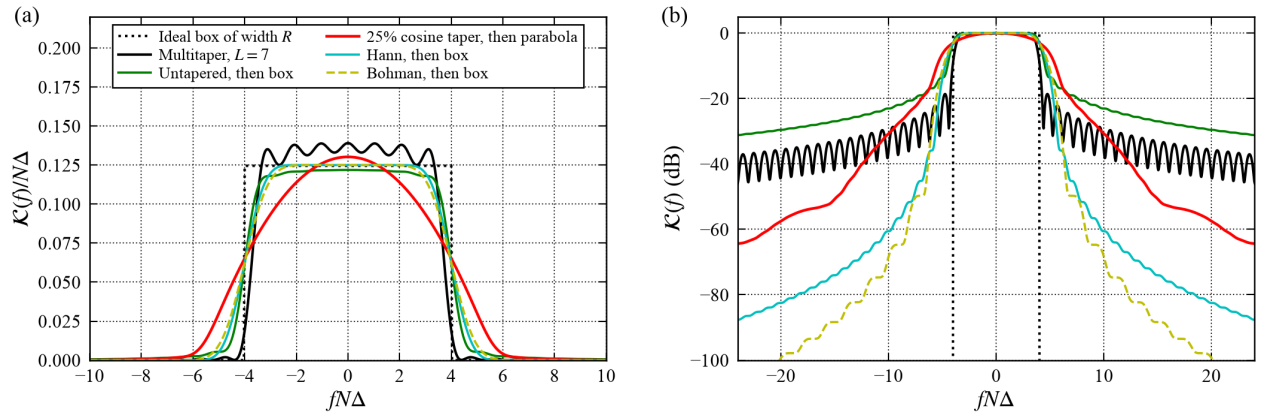


Figure S1. Kernels at the same design resolution ($N = 256$, $R = 8/(N\Delta)$; Table II), (a) on a linear scale near the main lobe and (b) in dB relative to the peak: the ideal box (dotted); the $L = 7$ multitaper kernel ($\nu = 14.0$, black); the periodogram after a 25% cosine taper followed by a parabola of the same half-power width ($\nu = 16.7$, red), which is recipe (b’); and the untapered ($\nu = 17.2$, green), Hann ($\nu = 8.9$, cyan) and Bohman ($\nu = 7.3$, olive, dashed) periodograms followed by the box. All main lobes have nearly the same half-power width, and the skirts differ by 40 dB.

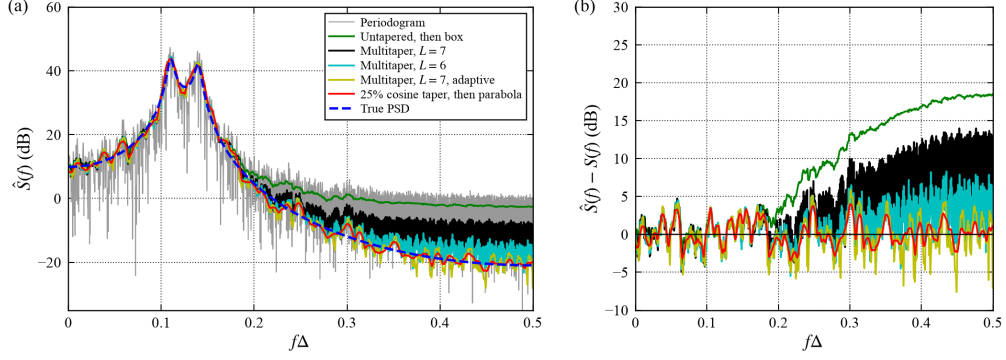


Figure S2. Dropping the leakiest taper. (a) One realization of the AR(4) process ($N = 1024$, $R = 8/(N\Delta)$): the periodogram ($\nu = 2$, grey); the untapered periodogram smoothed with the box ($\nu = 17.2$, green); the equal-weight multitaper estimate with $L = 7$ ($\nu = 14$, black) and with $L = 6$ ($\nu = 12$, cyan), and the adaptively weighted estimate with $L = 7$ (olive); the cosine-tapered periodogram smoothed with a parabola of half-power width R ($\nu = 16.7$, red); and the true PSD (blue, dashed). (b) Each smoothed estimate minus the true PSD: the untapered box floors 20 dB high, $L = 7$ floors 10 dB high, dropping the seventh taper halves that, and the adaptive weights and the smoothed periodogram track the truth.

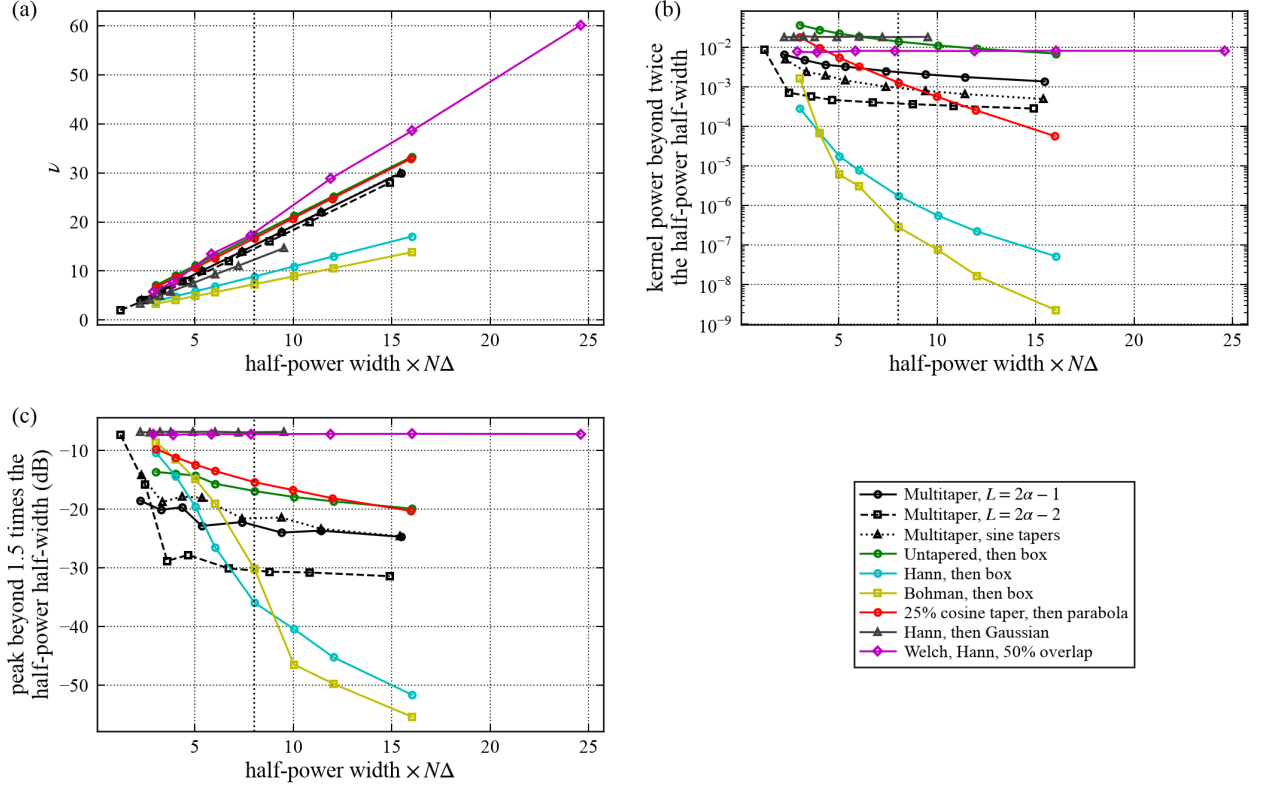


Figure S3. Variance, leakage and side-lobe level against the measured resolution, for $N = 256$. All curves are exact kernel and degrees-of-freedom computations, with no sampling variability. Each method's bandwidth parameter is swept and the quantities are plotted against the resulting half-power width, so methods are compared at equal resolution: multitaper with $L = 2\alpha - 1$ and $2\alpha - 2$ Slepian tapers and with sine tapers; untapered, Hann and Bohman periodograms followed by a box; a cosine-tapered periodogram followed by a parabola; a Hann periodogram followed by a Gaussian; Welch's method with 50% overlap. (a) Equivalent degrees of freedom ν (higher means less variance). (b) Kernel power beyond twice the half-power half-width. (c) The peak of the kernel beyond $1.5\times$ the half-power half-width. The Gaussian, parabolic and Welch kernels have no flat top, so for them this quantity is the skirt of the main lobe and not a side lobe. The dotted line marks the $8/(N\Delta)$ width of Table II, and the legend is at the lower right.

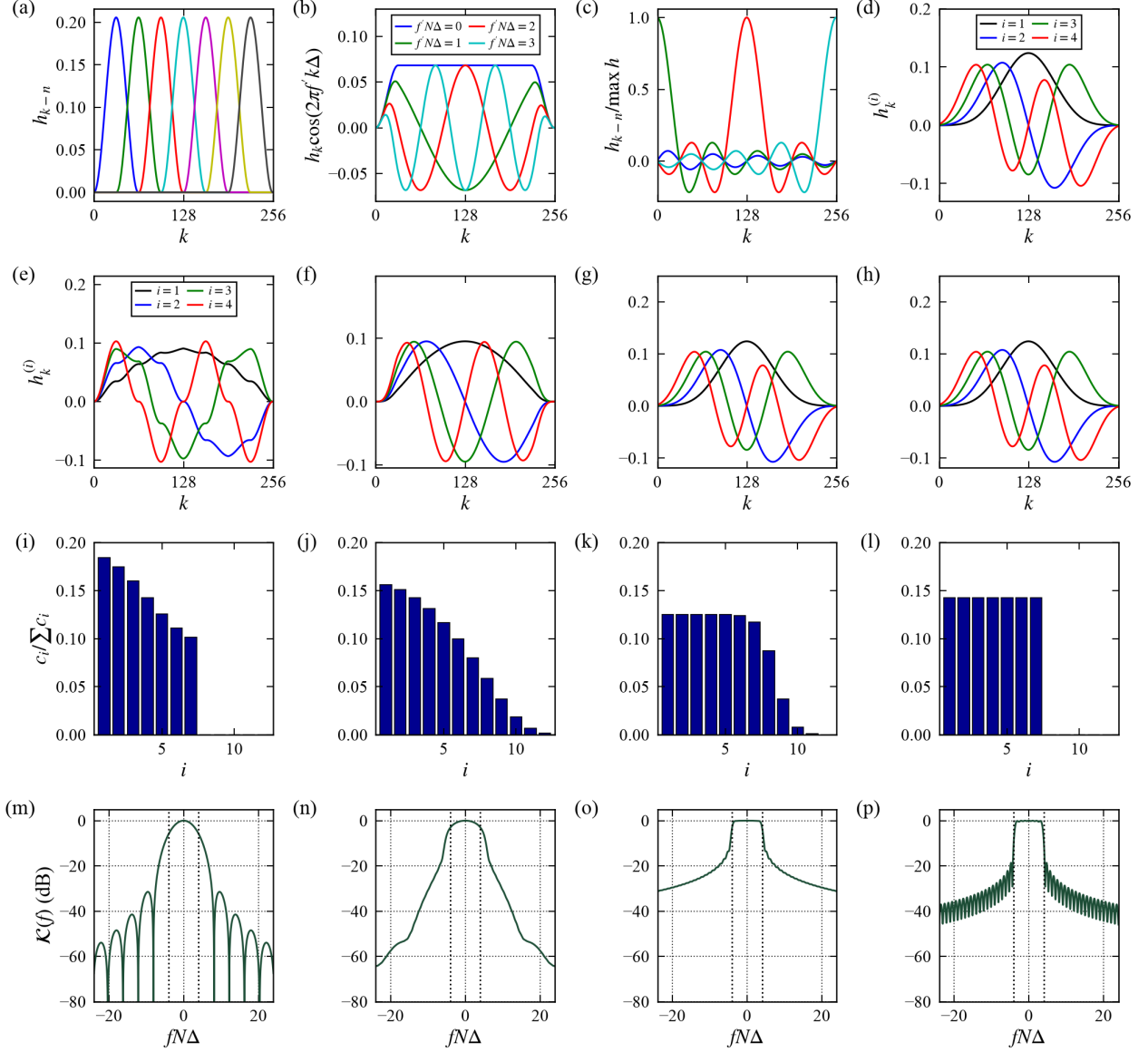


Figure S4. Fig. 5 in full. Columns as in Fig. 5; rows: the bank as constructed (a–d), the first four eigen-tapers of Q (e–h; for the sliding sinc they are the Slepian sequences, and for Thomson’s estimate, whose weights are equal, the Slepian sequences are one of many orthonormal bases of the span), the eigen-weight ladder (i–l), and the kernel in dB relative to its peak (m–p; dotted lines at $|f| = R/2$). The half-power widths of the kernels are 5.84, 8.03, 8.03 and 7.41/($N\Delta$), and 0.05%, 0.13%, 1.39% and 0.22% of their power lies outside $|f| \leq R$.